Kate Mezger

UX Design · Frontend Development · Research | Open to internship and full-time roles · Summer 2027

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Dallas | B.S. Cognitive Science (AI & HCI) | GPA: 3.69 — Expected May 2027

- Data Science Certificate (in progress)

Collin College | A.S. General Studies | GPA: 4.0 | Earned largely through dual credit in high school — Aug 2022 – Dec 2025

EXPERIENCE

Application Developer Intern (Frontend) | Cooperative Processing Resources (Cloverleaf CMS) — Aug 2026 – Present

- Ship production features in Vue.js and Quasar for Cloverleaf CMS, case management software for counseling agencies and credit unions
- Own client pages end to end, from usability-driven UI/UX redesign to production frontend code
- Design and build around real client workflows and compliance-sensitive data in an established codebase

Technology Designer & Officer | Artificial Intelligence Society, UT Dallas — Jun 2026 – Present

- Design and develop the membership portal **800+ members** use to apply to AI Academy, AIM, and Innovation Labs and RSVP
- Lead product design and web development across the society's web platforms as the tech team's design specialist

UX Researcher, Product Division | Nebula Labs, UT Dallas — Jan 2026 – Aug 2026

- Conducted 3 user interviews and co-moderated a ~30-person focus group for UTD Trends, UTD Notebook, and UTD Clubs
- Synthesized qualitative feedback into insights and product recommendations that informed design decisions

Game Master | Red Door Escape Room — Jul 2025 – Aug 2026

- Ran live, unscripted group sessions end to end, observing where players got stuck in real time and pacing hints on the fly
- Adapted hint timing and communication style to keep first-time and experienced players equally engaged

PROJECTS

TrackSense: F1 Prediction & Analytics Platform | UI/UX Designer & Frontend Lead | React, TypeScript — Jan 2026 – May 2026

- **1st place of 14 teams** at AI Society's AIM Night; invited by a judge to present to ~40 students at ITS AI/ML Camp
- Owned UI/UX design and frontend, turning Figma wireframes into 10 pages and 20+ reusable React components
- Designed views that make model output (live race telemetry, ELO ratings, XGBoost predictions) easy to read

Halo | Product Designer & Prototype Developer | Cognizant × Aston Martin Ideathon — Sep 2026 – Oct 2026

- **3rd place**: took an original concept from idea to working prototype in 6 weeks; presented to judges in Austin, TX

Time2Invest: Financial Literacy Simulator | WEHack 2026 | React, Vite, Supabase, Groq — Apr 2026

- Built in one hackathon: a simulator that gives users $10,000 and replays real headlines from historic market crashes
- Built the React, Vite, and TailwindCSS frontend; integrated Supabase (PostgreSQL) and Alpha Vantage for S&P 500 data
- Designed a "frozen-in-time" AI advisor on Groq that guides decisions without revealing hindsight answers

Steam Player Segmentation Engine | Python, FastAPI, scikit-learn — Jun 2026

- Built an end-to-end ML pipeline segmenting 200K Steam logs into 4 behavioral personas from 26 engineered metrics
- Corrected skew with Yeo-Johnson, reduced to 17 PCA components (87.3% variance), and clustered with K-Means (k=4)
- Deployed as a FastAPI microservice with Pydantic validation, serving **sub-15 ms** predictions from a REST endpoint

Eden Portfolio | React, Vite, Vercel — Aug 2026

- Designed, built, and deployed a responsive React portfolio presenting design, UX, and AI/ML work as case studies

SKILLS

Design: Figma, Framer, Webflow, Illustrator, Photoshop, wireframing, prototyping, interaction design, user flows, design systems
Research: User interviews, focus group moderation, usability testing, survey design, qualitative synthesis, personas
Frontend: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Vue.js, Quasar, Vite, TailwindCSS, HTML/CSS, responsive design, component libraries
Data & ML: Python, SQL, R, MATLAB, pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, XGBoost, Optuna, PCA, K-Means, Jupyter
Backend & Tools: FastAPI, Node.js, REST APIs, Supabase, PostgreSQL, C++, Git/GitHub, Vercel